

EAST SPRUCE DESIGN BUILD

About Us Page

Product Requirements Document v3.0
Modeled on the Adventure Wagon About Page Structure
February 2026

Project	East Spruce Design Build — About Page Redesign
Version	3.0 (About Page, AW-Inspired Structure)
Date	February 2026
Owner	Elliot Nolter, East Spruce Design Build (ESDB)
Prepared by	Joseph Pascucci, Three Rings Enterprises (3RE)
Reference	adventurewagon.com/pages/about (full page review conducted Feb 2026)
Related docs	v1.0 Full Site PRD • v2.0 Homepage PRD
Status	Draft — Awaiting Designer Review

1. What Makes the AW About Page Work

The Adventure Wagon About page is structurally one of the best-executed About pages in the product/service space. After a full review of adventurewagon.com/pages/about, here is what makes it effective — and why each principle translates directly to ESDB.

AW Design Principle	Why It Works	ESDB Application
Full-viewport hero with video	<i>Puts you in the brand immediately. The video says more in 60 seconds than any paragraph could.</i>	Use a project walkthrough or studio tour video. If not ready, a full-bleed project photo is a strong stand-in.
Founder origin story, told personally	<i>'Our story starts the way a lot of good ones do: with a road trip.' Specific, human, memorable. Polaroid-style photos make it tactile.</i>	Elliot's story is equally compelling: childhood drawing, Penn State Solar Decathlon, 9 years in traditional firm, founding ESDB. Tell it like a person, not a LinkedIn bio.
Repeating 'pillar' sections	<i>Each differentiator (Your Layout / More Than Modular / One Stop Shop / Install Options / Quality / Support) gets its own full section: bold headline + 2–3 paragraphs + framed photo + CTA.</i>	ESDB has equally strong pillars: Designer-Led / Integrated Model / Sustainability Default / Craft & Materials / The Studio / The Relationship. Each gets its own section.
Text left, photo right (alternating)	<i>The left-text/right-photo rhythm is easy to scan. AW keeps images in a distinctive 'bracket' frame (orange corner accents) for visual brand consistency.</i>	Use the same alternating left/right rhythm. ESDB's frame treatment can use teal accent corners or a clean white border — whatever the designer proposes for brand consistency.
Each section has its own CTA	<i>Every pillar ends with a specific action: 'Build Your Dream Van →', 'Compare Install Options →', 'Get in Touch →'. Visitors are never left wondering what to do next.</i>	Each ESDB section CTA routes to the most relevant page: 'See Our Work →', 'Our Services →', 'Start a Project →'.
Team photo closes it	<i>The 'Customer Service + Support' section ends with a team photo. It humanizes the company right before the final lifestyle close.</i>	Close with Elliot and any team members in or around the studio/carriage house. Warm, approachable, real.
Full-bleed lifestyle close	<i>No text. Just an aspirational image of people enjoying their van. Emotional resonance as the final impression.</i>	A completed ESDB project, ideally with people living in it — kitchen moment, reading nook, family in the space. Emotion over information.

2. Adventure Wagon About Page — Section Map

Observed at adventurewagon.com/pages/about. Scrolled top to bottom, February 2026.

#	Section	AW Content	Structural Role
1	Full-Viewport Hero	Full-bleed outdoor photo + 'About Adventure Wagon' title + subhead + video play button ('PLAY NOW')	Immediate immersion; video does the heavy lifting on brand emotion
2	Origin Story	Left: bold headline 'Our Story Starts the Way a Lot of Good Ones Do: With a Road Trip' + 4 paragraphs (founder Chad, \$2k, VW van, the idea). Right: two stacked Polaroid-style photos.	Makes the brand human and personal; builds founder-level trust
3	Your Van. Your Layout.	Left: product philosophy paragraphs (modular system adapts to your life). Right: framed product photo. CTA: 'Build Your Dream Van →'	Explains the core product promise in one section
4	More Than Modular.	Left: steel A-frame / L-track explanation, freedom theme. Right: framed interior photo. CTA: 'Learn More About Our Interior System →'	Differentiator #1 — unique mechanism that competitors can't match
5	One Stop Shop.	Left: complete kit explanation, curated gear. Right: framed gear photo. CTA: 'Shop Gear →'	Drives commerce; positions AW as the complete solution
6	Flexible Install Options.	Left: DIY / factory / certified installer options, 2–4 week timeline. Right: framed installation photo. CTA: 'Compare Install Options →'	Handles the 'how does this actually work?' objection
7	Quality + Durability.	Left: craftsmanship language, steel/aluminum/marine-grade materials, 3-year warranty. Right: framed interior photo. CTA: 'Compare Install Options →'	Handles the 'is this actually good?' objection
8	Customer Service + Support.	Left: relationship language ('that support doesn't expire'). Right: team group photo in front of a van. CTA: 'Get in Touch →'	Humanizes the company; shows real people; builds post-purchase confidence
9	Full-Bleed Lifestyle Close	Full-width photo of couple relaxing by van at campsite. No text overlay. Pure emotion.	Final impression — aspiration and belonging
10	Footer	Multi-column nav + 'Join the Journey' newsletter signup	Navigation + list growth

3. East Spruce About Page — Section-by-Section Specifications

The following specs follow the same sequence as the AW About page. Each section maps directly to an AW equivalent. The layout pattern throughout the page is: bold headline + 2–3 paragraphs + framed photo (alternating left/right) + contextual CTA button. This rhythm is what gives the page its confidence and scannability.

Section 1: Hero — Full Viewport with Video

Layout	Full-bleed project or studio photo. Centered headline overlay. Video play button below subhead.
Headline	Hero — Full Viewport with Video
Copy brief	'About East Spruce' as page label (small, above headline). Bold headline: e.g. 'Built from Passion. Guided by Principle.' Subhead: one sentence on who ESDB is. Video play button labeled 'Watch Our Story' or 'See the Process'.
CTA	Video play button — opens project walkthrough, studio tour, or Elliot speaking about the philosophy (60–90 sec)
Photo	Drone shot of completed project or exterior of the carriage house studio — chosen for visual drama and natural light — Warm natural light, outdoor or semi-outdoor setting; conveys craft and care. If video not ready at launch, the play button can be hidden and revealed in Phase 2.

AW: Full-viewport hero + video	ESDB: Full-viewport hero + video
Full-bleed outdoor action photo. 'About Adventure Wagon' title. Subhead: 'Modular isn't just how we build—it's why.' Video play button: 'PLAY NOW'.	Same structure. Photo: completed ESDB project or studio exterior. Headline: 'Built from Passion. Guided by Principle.' Subhead: 'East Spruce is a licensed architecture and design/build studio founded on the belief that buildings should be beautiful, sustainable, and built to last.'
📌 Design Note: AW's subhead explains the product philosophy in one sentence. ESDB's should do the same for its service philosophy. The video is the highest-leverage element on this page — even a 60-second iPhone walkthrough of the carriage house studio would be powerful.	

Section 2: Our Story

Layout	Text left (60%), photo right (40%). Photo: stacked or overlapping casual/archival photos — Polaroid-style or natural border treatment.
Headline	Our Story
Copy brief	Headline: 'Our Story Starts Where Most Architecture Stories Don't: Outside.' Paragraph 1: childhood drawing, building outdoors, classical art at Barnstone Studios. Paragraph 2: Penn

	State Solar Decathlon — designing and building an off-grid net-zero home. Paragraph 3: 9 years in a traditional architecture firm. Paragraph 4: founding ESDB in 2018 — the desire to return to the work itself, to design and build, not just document. Closing line: bold, memorable ending sentence about what drives the work.
CTA	None needed in this section — pure story. Or an optional secondary link: 'Meet Elliot →' scrolls to Section 5.
Photo	Archival or casual photos: Elliot as a student, Solar Decathlon build, early project, or studio before/after renovation. Stacked at slight angles for a tactile, personal feel. — Personal, archival feel. Candid over polished. Stacked photos (like AW's Polaroids) suggest a real journey, not a stock photo shoot.

■ AW: Origin Story — 'A Road Trip'	■ ESDB: Origin Story — 'A Drawing and a Shovel'
Headline: 'Our story starts the way a lot of good ones do: with a road trip.' Founder Chad left \$2,000 by grandfather to travel. VW van. First Mule Bags. Eventually: Adventure Wagon. Polaroid-style photos of old vans and Chad with family.	Headline: 'Our story starts the way most good ones do: with a childhood obsession and a lot of ambition.' Elliot drawing, Barnstone Studios, Solar Decathlon, 9 years at a firm, 2018 founding. Photo: Elliot in the studio or an archival image of the carriage house renovation.
📌 Design Note: AW's story is externally triggered (grandfather's gift). Elliot's story is internally driven — a calling, not a circumstance. That's actually a stronger narrative for a craft-based business. Lean into the 'I had to do this' framing.	

Section 3: The Studio — Where We Work

Layout	Text left (60%), photo right (40%). Photo on right. Background: light warm grey or white.
Headline	The Studio — Where We Work
Copy brief	Headline: 'A Studio That Practices What It Preaches.' Paragraph 1: ESDB is housed in a renovated 19th-century carriage house in Bethlehem, PA. Paragraph 2: The studio is fossil-fuel free — EV charging, indoor bike storage, smart daylighting, solar near net-zero. Paragraph 3: Most of the materials in the renovation are salvaged or sustainably sourced — the building IS the portfolio. Closing point: the studio isn't a backdrop. It's proof of concept.
CTA	Optional: 'See Our Work →' — links to /portfolio
Photo	Interior or exterior of the renovated 19th-century carriage house. Warm natural light. Shows materials: salvaged wood, exposed structure, EV charger, bike storage. — Interior shot works best here — shows the character of the space. Warm, handcrafted quality. Salvaged materials visible. Not a sterile office.

■ AW: Your Van. Your Layout. (product philosophy)	■ ESDB: The Studio — Where We Work
Core product promise: modular system adapts to your life, not the other way around. Starts simple, grows with you. CTA: 'Build Your Dream Van →'	ESDB doesn't have a product to show here, but it has something equally powerful: a physical space that IS the proof of concept. The carriage house renovation demonstrates that ESDB lives the philosophy. This section earns immediate credibility.
📌 Design Note: AW uses this slot for 'product in use.' ESDB uses it for 'philosophy in practice.' Both answer the same visitor question: 'Do these people actually believe what they say?' The carriage house is ESDB's answer.	

Section 4: The Philosophy — Sustainability as Default

Layout	Text left (60%), photo right (40%). Background: near-white or light warm tone. Photo on right.
Headline	The Philosophy — Sustainability as Default
Copy brief	Headline: 'Sustainability Isn't a Feature. It's How We Think.' Paragraph 1: Most firms offer sustainability as an upgrade. At ESDB it's the baseline — how we approach every siting decision, every material selection, every energy system. Paragraph 2: Explain the SAVE framework (Sustainability = Saving time, money, resources, energy) in plain language — not as a list, but woven into a paragraph. Paragraph 3: The most sustainable building is one that's already standing — our bias is always toward what can be preserved, repurposed, or adapted. New construction is designed to last 100 years.
CTA	'Learn About Our Approach →' — links to /services or a sustainability consulting sub-section
Photo	A high-performance building detail — wall assembly, insulation, solar panel on the studio roof, or a material close-up showing craftsmanship. Should look technical but beautiful. — A beautiful material or building science detail — wood grain, insulation panel, energy system. Shows that sustainability is tactile and beautiful, not clinical.

■ AW: More Than Modular. (differentiator #1)	■ ESDB: Sustainability as Default (differentiator #1)
<i>Steel A-frame and L-track as unique mechanism. Freedom to reconfigure. Designed to evolve with you. CTA: 'Learn More About Our Interior System →'</i>	ESDB's unique mechanism isn't a product — it's a philosophy applied consistently. Sustainability as default, not add-on. The SAVE framework. 100-year design horizon. This is the differentiator that most design/build firms can't credibly claim.
📌 Design Note: AW's 'unique mechanism' is the modular A-frame/L-track system. ESDB's is the integrated sustainability-first mindset applied to every project from day one. Both are differentiators competitors can't easily copy.	

Section 5: The Person — Meet Elliot

Layout	Text left (60%), photo right (40%). Background: white. Photo on right.
Headline	The Person — Meet Elliot
Copy brief	Headline: 'Meet Elliot Nolter, RA CPHC SHP.' Paragraph 1: Licensed architect (PA + NJ), Certified Passive House Consultant, Sustainable Homes Professional. Studied classical art at Barnstone Studios; B.Arch Penn State. Paragraph 2: The personal dimension — outdoor enthusiast, steward of the planet, the belief that our #1 responsibility is to the place we live and the people we share it with. Paragraph 3: What this means in practice — Elliot is involved in every project from first conversation to final walkthrough. This isn't a firm that hands projects off. Credentials listed as visual badge icons below the text (not in a bullet list).

CTA	Optional: 'Start a Conversation →' — links to /contact
Photo	Portrait of Elliot — in the studio, on a job site, or outdoors. Should feel warm and confident, not corporate headshot. Natural light preferred. — Relaxed, approachable portrait — not a formal headshot. In the studio or on a site is ideal. Shows the person behind the credentials.

AW: Customer Service + Support. (team section)	ESDB: Meet Elliot (the person behind the work)
<i>'Van conversion is just the beginning.' Long-term relationship language. Support doesn't expire. Team group photo in front of a van. CTA: 'Get in Touch →'</i>	AW uses their team section to humanize the company and build confidence. ESDB has an even stronger asset: the founder himself is the differentiator. His credentials, values, and personal involvement in every project are what clients are actually hiring. This section closes the trust loop.
📌 Design Note: AW's team section works because it shows real people. For ESDB, Elliot IS the brand in Phase 1 — the personal connection to him is the whole point. As the team grows, this section becomes a proper team page. For now, it's a founder portrait that earns the consultation request.	

Section 6: Credentials & Certifications

AW: No direct AW equivalent	ESDB: Credentials Strip
<i>AW uses product specs and materials to convey quality. They don't have professional certifications to display.</i>	A compact, visually clean horizontal strip displaying ESDB's professional credentials and affiliations as badges or icons. This is unique to a licensed professional services firm and has no AW equivalent — it's a significant trust signal that should not be buried in a paragraph.
📌 Design Note: This section should feel like a badge wall, not a resume. Each credential should be a small icon or emblem with a brief label. Keep it horizontal and compact — one row, not a grid. Position it directly after the 'Meet Elliot' section while the trust is warm.	

CREDENTIALS TO DISPLAY

- Licensed Architect — Pennsylvania
- Licensed Architect — New Jersey
- Certified Passive House Consultant (CPHC) — PHIUS
- Sustainable Homes Professional (SHP)
- Penn State Solar Decathlon Alumni
- AIA Member (if applicable — confirm with Elliot)
- Houzz profile / rating badge (if strong)
- Google review badge (if available)

DESIGN NOTES

- Layout: horizontal row of badge icons, centered, with label below each
- Background: light grey or white — let the credentials breathe
- Font: small, clean, same font family as rest of page
- Keep it tight — this should feel like a quiet confidence moment, not a wall of logos

Section 7: Global Lifestyle / Closing CTA (From Homepage)

■ AW: Full-Bleed Lifestyle Emotional Close

Full-width outdoor photo of a couple relaxing by their van. Left-side text overlay: 'STEP BY STEP — Our van configurator walks you through each choice.' CTA: 'GET IN TOUCH →'. Emotional payoff of the whole homepage.

■ ESDB: Full-Bleed Emotional Close

Full-width photo of a completed, beautiful, livable ESDB project — a family in their renovated kitchen, a couple in a sunlit addition, or a home exterior at golden hour. Left-side text: a short headline about the outcome, not the process. Single CTA: 'Start Your Project →'.

📌 Design Note: AW's closing image shows people enjoying the result. ESDB should do the same — not a construction site, not a blueprint, but the feeling of having made the right choice. This is the emotional close of the entire homepage journey.

SEE HOMEPAGE FOR FULL DETAILS

- Recycled global component
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4. Full About Page — Section Order Summary

The complete ESDB About page section sequence, ready to hand to a designer as a wireframe brief. Every section follows the AW pattern: bold headline + 2–3 paragraphs + framed photo (alternating sides) + CTA.

#	ESDB Section	AW Parallel	Photo	CTA
1	Hero — Full Viewport + Video	<i>About AW hero + video</i>	Dramatic project/studio photo	'Watch Our Story' video play button
2	Our Story (founder narrative)	<i>Origin story — road trip</i>	Stacked casual/archival photos	None (or 'Meet Elliot →' anchor)
3	The Studio — Where We Work	<i>Your Van. Your Layout.</i>	Carriage house interior/exterior	'See Our Work →' → /portfolio
4	Sustainability as Default	<i>More Than Modular.</i>	Building science detail or material	'Our Services →' → /services
5	Meet Elliot	<i>Customer Service + Support.</i>	Warm portrait — studio or site	'Start a Conversation →' → /contact
6	Credentials Strip	<i>No AW equivalent</i>	Badge icons (no photo needed)	None — credentials speak for themselves
7	Global Lifestyle Close	<i>Lifestyle photo close</i>	People in a completed ESDB space	'Get In Touch →' — links to /contact
8	Footer	<i>Footer + Join the Journey</i>	N/A	Newsletter signup

5. Repeating Layout Pattern — Designer Brief

The core visual pattern that runs through sections 2–5 is inherited directly from AW. Each section is a horizontal split: text block on one side, framed photo on the other, alternating with each section.

The AW 'Pillar Section' Pattern — Applied to ESDB

Repeat this structure for sections 2, 3, 4, and 5

TEXT BLOCK (left on odd sections, right on even)

BOLD SECTION HEADLINE (28–32pt, all-caps or title case)

Paragraph 1: opening statement / brand claim

Paragraph 2: expansion / specific detail

Paragraph 3: proof or consequence

[CTA BUTTON] →

FRAMED PHOTO (right on odd sections, left on even)

AW uses distinctive bracket/corner accent treatment. ESDB: designer to propose equivalent brand frame (teal corner accents, thin white border, or clean bleed).

Photo is taller than wide (portrait orientation preferred on desktop — fills the column naturally)

AW orange corner brackets = brand signature. ESDB teal equivalents would create same recognition.

ALTERNATING SIDES BY SECTION

- Section 2 (Origin Story): text LEFT, photos RIGHT
- Section 3 (The Studio): text LEFT, photo RIGHT
- Section 4 (Philosophy): text LEFT, photo RIGHT
- Section 5 (Meet Elliot): text LEFT, photo RIGHT
- Note: AW alternates in some versions. Designer may vary for visual rhythm — flag if alternating is preferred.

SECTION DIVIDERS

- AW uses a thin orange horizontal rule between each pillar section
 - ESDB: use a thin teal or light grey rule, or generous white space between sections
 - The divider signals 'new thought' without a hard break
-

6. Copy Prompts for Each Section

The following are working headlines and copy direction for each section. These are starting points — placeholder text is okay for later refinement before publishing.

Section	Headline Options (pick one)	Opening Sentence Direction
Hero	A) Built from Passion. Guided by Principle. B) Where Architecture Meets Craft. C) Sustainable Design. Built Right. Built to Last.	<i>One sentence. Who ESDB is, where they are, what they believe.</i>
Our Story	A) Our Story Starts the Way Most Good Ones Do: With a Drawing and a Dream. B) It Started With a Ridiculous Amount of Drawing. C) Fifteen Years of Learning. Five Years of Building. One Studio.	<i>Open with Elliot as a child. Not 'ESDB was founded in 2018.' The childhood detail is the hook.</i>
The Studio	A) A Studio That Practices What It Preaches. B) Our Office Is Our Portfolio. C) Fossil-Fuel Free Since Day One.	<i>Lead with the surprise: a 19th-century carriage house that is now completely fossil-fuel free.</i>
Philosophy	A) Sustainability Isn't a Feature. It's How We Think. B) We Don't Offer a Green Option. It's the Only Option. C) The Most Sustainable Building Is One That's Already Standing.	<i>The SAVE framework: Sustainability = Saving time, money, resources, energy. Not as a list — woven into prose.</i>
Meet Elliot	A) Meet Elliot Nolter — Architect, Builder, Believer. B) Every Project. Every Decision. One Architect. C) He Designed It. He Built It. He'll Be There When You Move In.	<i>Credentials first (brief: RA, CPHC, SHP, PA+NJ licensed). Then the person: outdoor enthusiast, steward, the outdoor childhood.</i>

7. Content Checklist for the About Page

#	Asset Needed	Owner	Status
1	Hero photo: high-res dramatic project or studio exterior shot	Elliot	Photo needed
2	Video (60–90 sec): studio tour, project walkthrough, or Elliot on philosophy	Elliot + Joe	Decision needed
3	Archival/casual photos for Origin Story: Elliot as student, Solar Decathlon, early work	Elliot	Personal archive
4	Studio photos: interior of carriage house with natural light (2–3 shots)	Elliot	Photo needed
5	Philosophy/material detail photo: building science detail, insulation, material close-up	Elliot	Photo needed
6	Portrait of Elliot: relaxed, warm, in studio or on site	Elliot	Photo needed
7	Credential logos/badge files: PHIUS CPHC, SHP, AIA, PA & NJ license seals	Elliot	Digital files needed
8	Lifestyle close photo: completed ESDB project with people inhabiting the space	Elliot	Photo needed
9	Finalized copy for all 5 pillar sections (draft in this doc, refine with Joe)	Elliot + Joe	Drafts in Section 6
10	Google/Houzz review badge if embedding a live rating widget	Elliot	Setup needed

This PRD covers the About page only. See v1.0 (Full Site PRD) and v2.0 (Homepage PRD) for complete site specifications.

— End of Document —

Questions or revisions? Contact Joseph Pascucci, or Elliot Nolter, East Spruce Design Build.